

Chapter 7

Live on Less Than You Make Millionaires Practice Intentionality

In 1991, my college football team won a national championship. We had worked hard and played hard all season, and we became the first team in the school's history to win a national title. We were pumped. All the blood, sweat, and tears we left on the field all year had paid off, and those teammates had become like brothers to me. To commemorate the incredible year we'd had, all the guys decided to get a team tattoo on their legs—a constant reminder of what we had achieved together. I wanted that tiger paw tattoo more than almost anything, but I couldn't do it. As the guys left for the tattoo parlor, I could hear some of them saying, "Hey! Hogan's not coming!" I don't think I've ever felt more left out in my life.

So, why didn't I go? Well, I mentioned earlier that I planned on becoming an FBI agent. That meant, even as a college student, I had to be intentional about the decisions I made. I couldn't get a victory tattoo because I couldn't get any permanent distinguishing marks on my body. That tiger paw, cool as it was, could have gotten me killed in the line of duty! As much as I wanted to join my brothers in celebrating our victory, I had another goal in mind—a long-term goal that directed many of the decisions I made as a young man. I knew, if I really wanted to be an agent, I had to be intentional about how I acted, my grades, where I went to school, and the people I hung out with. The picture of myself as an FBI agent became the lens through which I viewed different choices and